BEST BRAIN EXAMINATIONS KONSORTIUM
SPECIAL PRIVATE MOCK EXAMINATIONS FOR BECE CANDIDATES – **OCTOBER 2026**
MARKING SCHEME – **ENGLISH LANGUAGE**

PAPER 2 [60 MARKS]

PART A – WRITING [30 MARKS]

GENERAL PREAMBLE

1. **There are three parts- A, B and C.** Candidates are expected to answer three questions in all, ONE question from PART A and Questions 4 & 5. If a candidate attempts more than one question from PART A, mark BOTH and choose the better of the two.
2. The required length of each composition is **250 words.**
3. **Mark Allocation**: Each composition is to be marked out of a total of 30 marks distributed as follows:

(a) CONTENT **10 MARKS**

Ensure that the candidate presents a set of relevant points or details that are central to the theme or essay topic.

(b) ORGANIZATION **5 MARKS**

The writing must be judged as whatever it is intended to be: an article, a speech, a letter, a debate, etc. Look for suitable layout, suitable opening, adequate development, good paragraph, balance, coherence and a suitable conclusion.

(c) EXPRESSION **10 MARKS**

Look out for correct usage of language, variation of sentence structure and type, judicious use of figurative language, and skillful use of punctuation. In arriving at the mark for expression, do not be unduly influenced by mechanical errors.

(d) MECHANICAL ACCURACY **5 MARKS**

Look out for undeniable errors in grammar, punctuation and spelling.

4. If a candidate writes on a topic other than the one set, award zero (0) for Content and mark Expression out of 5. The allocations for organization and Mechanical Accuracy remain unchanged.
5. Each ring should attract a deduction of half a mark (½). Formal features of letters should have two rings only counted against Mechanical Accuracy. Subsequent errors in the formal features should be underlined only.
6. In general, the principle of positive marking should be applied, i.e., give credit for what the candidate has done right and then penalize for errors. These penalties are not, in all cases, numerical deductions but often the reward of a lower mark than would have been earned if there were no blemishes.
7. The candidate is expected to know the simple mechanics of the English Language. These include spelling, punctuation, subject-verb concord, noun-pronoun agreement and the use of the capital letter. He or she should also be able to control the use of determiners, quantifiers, prepositions, etc.
8. **Penalize**

(i) ***Each Grammatical Error*:** These include

- the omission of an essential sentence element
- wrong tense;
- misuse or omission of the article;
- misuse of modal operators (may/might, etc)
- confusion or ambiguity in the use of pronouns;
- misuse of countable and uncountable nouns;
- wrong prepositions;
- misuse of relatives/subordinators/ conjunctions;
- errors in concord;
- intransitive verbs for transitive and vice versa;
- active for passive and vice versa;
- faulty construction.

(ii) ***The wrong amalgamation or breaking up of words e.g.***

"inspite" for in spite
"infront" for in front
"every where" for everywhere
"to day" for today
"every body" for everybody
"ofcourse" for of course
"infact" for in fact
"never the less" for nevertheless
"how ever" for however
"more over" for moreover
"now a days" for nowadays,
etc.

(iii) ***Wrong Spelling*** – the wrong spelling of the same word should be penalized only once. American spelling, if consistent, should be accepted.

(iv) ***Punctuation Error and the Wrong Use of the Capital Letter.***

- Each full stop, question mark or exclamation mark omitted or wrongly used; the misuse or omission of quotation marks. Both single and double quotation marks are accepted, but consistency is to be demanded.
- The insertion of a comma between subject and verb, subject and object, verb and complement, in simple structures only, i.e., where phrases or clauses do not intervene.

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- The insertion of comma between adjective and noun, or verb and adverb; the omission of a comma used to separate items in a list of words, phrases or clauses.
- The use of a small letter for pronoun 'I'; use of a small letter at the beginning of a proper noun or sentence.
- Where a proper noun consists of more than one element, each of which is expected to begin with a capital letter eg. Electricity Company of Ghana, there should be only one penalty for the group.
- Initials in abbreviations with or without full stop should be accepted, eg G.C.B or GCB, W.A.E.C or WAEC. First and last letters: both forms should be accepted, eg. Dr and Dr.; Mrs and Mrs.

NB: ***This list is not exhaustive. It is merely to indicate the type of undeniable errors to be penalized.]***

9. Each of these errors should be ringed and half a mark (½) deducted up to a total of 5 marks

10. ASSESSMENT GUIDE

	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Average	Below Average	Illiterate
Content	9 – 10	7 - 8	6	5	3 - 4	0 - 2½
Organization	5	4 – 4½	3 - 3½	1½ - 2	1 - 1½	0 - 1
Expression	9 – 10	7 - 8	6	5	3 - 4	0 - 2½

Number of words		
5 words on a line	=	50 lines
6 words on a line	=	42 lines
7 words on a line	=	36 lines
8 words on a line	=	31 lines
9 words on a line	=	28 lines
10 words on a line	=	25 lines
11 words on a line	=	23 lines
12 words on a line	=	21 lines
13 words on a line	=	19 lines

Number of Words		Mechanical Accuracy
250 words	=	5
225 words	=	4½
200 words	=	4
175 words	=	3½
150 words	=	3
100 words	=	2
75 words	=	1½
50 words	=	1
25 words	=	½

QUESTION 1

CONTENT – 10 MARKS –

The candidate should briefly introduce the historic site in the introduction. We expect the candidate to mention at least two reasons why the historic site should be protected and two ways of preserving it. Both parts should be adequately treated for a good mark. If only one part is treated, mark out of 3 marks; if two, mark out of 7.

ORGANISATION – 5 MARKS

This is a formal letter, so the following formal features must be present:

(i) Writer's address and date
(ii) Recipient's address
(iii) Salutation – Dear Sir/Madam
(iv) Heading/Title
(v) Body of letter -- Introduction, Main Content, Conclusion
(vi) Subscription – Yours faithfully
(vii) Writer's signature and full name

The candidate should show a good introduction and conclusion. Each paragraph should be properly developed and linked. A mere listing of points should not score more than 2 marks.

EXPRESSION – 10 MARKS

The language should be formal. The candidate should avoid slang, contracted forms, colloquialisms and conversational expressions. Diction and register should be appropriate. The candidate should vary sentence patterns and use appropriate punctuation.

MECHANICAL ACCURACY – 5 MARKS

As in the general marking guidelines.

QUESTION 2

CONTENT – 10 MARKS -The candidate is to present a speech for or against the motion: *"The Basic School Curriculum Should Be Revised."* The candidate should advance two strong points to support the stance taken. These points may include issues such as outdated content, relevance to current needs, practical skills, technology, academic pressure, employability, or students' holistic development. Three points may score 6 marks or more. Two points should score not more than 5 marks. One point should score not more than 3 marks

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ORGANISATION – 5 MARKS

This is an argument. The candidate has to take a stance; that is, clearly state whether he supports or opposes the motion. An argument without a clearly stated stance should have the mark reduced to 3 under *Organization* so that the candidate should get some mark out of 3.

EXPRESSION – 10 MARKS

The language should be formal. Register and diction should reflect the situation. The candidate is expected to use long and short sentences. The candidate should use appropriate style and other relevant devices and techniques

MECHANICAL ACCURACY – 5 MARKS

As in the preamble.

QUESTION 3

CONTENT – 10 MARKS

The candidate is to describe three main differences noticed between life in the relative's town and life in the candidate's own home town. The candidate should clearly describe the differences observed. These may include issues such as the environment, means of transport, occupations, housing, social life, availability of services, lifestyle, or other relevant differences. Three points may score 6 marks or more. Two points should score not more than 5 marks. One point should score not more than 3 marks.

ORGANISATION – 5 MARKS

This is a descriptive essay. The candidate should have a good introduction, body and conclusion. The three differences should be clearly presented and developed in separate paragraphs. A mere listing of points should not score more than 2 marks. Good paragraphing should be rewarded.

EXPRESSION – 10 MARKS

The language should be clear and descriptive. Register and diction should be appropriate to the situation. The candidate is expected to use varied sentence patterns, descriptive expressions and appropriate vocabulary. The candidate should use appropriate style and other relevant devices and techniques.

MECHANICAL ACCURACY – 5 MARKS

As in the preamble.

PART B - READING [20 marks]

PENALTIES FOR QUESTION 4

(a) Deduct half a mark for any grammatical/expression error(s) at each scoring point.
(b) Where a candidate gives two answers to a question and one of them is wrong, award zero. If, however, both answers are correct award full marks.
(c) Where words /expressions are expected to be given to replace words /expressions in the passage, they must fit in perfectly. Otherwise, award zero.
(d) Answers need not be written in sentences, unless otherwise stipulated.
(e) An answer, taken as a whole, must make sense before any part of it may be accepted for scoring.
(f) Question 4(f) (*Explanation of expressions)*
  (i) Award zero (0) if any content/ main word in the expression being tested is repeated.
  (ii) Award zero (0) if a candidate uses fixed expressions (idioms, phrasal verbs …..)
(g) Question 4(h) (*Summary)*
  (i) Award half the allocated mark if the answer is not written in a complete sentence.
  (ii) Apt lifting within the stipulated number of words is allowed.
  (iii) Deduct half a mark (½) if an answer exceeds the required number of words (extraneous material)
  (iv) Deduct half a mark (½) for any grammatical/ expression error in a correct answer.
  (v) Deduct half a mark (½) for any extraneous material in a correct answer

QUESTION 4 [20 MARKS]

(a) Her crops were dying/She was unsure what she could do at the farm because her crops were dying **[2 marks]**
(b) There was insufficient water to grow crops. **[2 marks]**
(c) When conditions became worse/When water shortage became acute/ When there was no work to do. **[2 marks]**
(d) Unproductive/Vulnerable/Weak(Aged / Old/ Dependent/ Skewed/ Imbalanced) **[1 mark]**
(e) (i) The birds eating the pawpaw. **[1 mark]**
  (ii) The rain **[1 mark]**
(f) (i) *dampen her spirits* - discourage her/make her lose hope/ demoralize her **[½ mark]**
  (ii) *shrugged her shoulders* –showed resignation / showed indifference / accepted the situation **[½ mark]**
  (iii) *make do with* – manage/ take as it is/ accept to live with/ go with/ live with **[½ mark]**
  (iv) *from time immemorial* – from ancient times/ for a very long time/ for so many years/ **[½ mark]**
  (v) *had hardly finished* – was nowhere near completion/ was still on it/had just finished **[½ mark]**
  (vi) *try as she did* – no matter how she managed/ despite the efforts she made/ in spite of every attempt **[½ mark]**

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(g) (i) *quite* – too/ very/ completely/ somewhat/ fairly/ rather/ really/ pretty/ reasonably [½ mark]
(ii) *thought* – believed/ assumed/ imagined/ supposed/concluded/ held, presumed, expected [½ mark]
(iii) *scanty* – small/ little/ limited/ slight/ insufficient/ inadequate [½ mark]
(iv) *exhausted*- worn-out/ tired/ used up/ finished/ depleted/ drained/ fatigued/ [½ mark]
(v) *barren* – infertile/ poor/ unproductive/ impoverished/ unfertile/ unfruitful/ [½ mark]
(vi) *abundant* – plentiful / ample / plentifully available / enough [½ mark]
(vii) *economize* – save / spend less / reduce expenditure [½ mark]
(viii) *disaster* – catastrophe/tragedy/calamity/ misfortune/ tragedy/ failure/adversity/ blow [½ mark]

(h) (i) Crops failed/died, leaving farmers without enough food.
Many young people left the village in search of better opportunities.
The villagers struggled to get enough water.
Abida's sons left her to manage the farm alone
Any 2 correct @ 1 mark each = [2 marks]

(ii) The Effects of Drought on Domeabra
Life During a Period of Drought
Drought and Its Effects on the Village
The Struggles of Abida and Her Village.
Any one correct @ 2 marks = [2 marks]

PART C- LITERATURE [10 marks]

PENALTIES FOR QUESTION 5

(a) Deduct half a mark for any grammatical/expression error(s) at each scoring point.
(b) Where a candidate gives two answers to a question and one of them is wrong, award zero (o). If, however, both answers are correct award full marks.
(c) An answer, taken as a whole, must make sense before any part of it may be accepted for scoring.
(d) Award zero if a candidate spells a name, a literary device, etc. wrongly

Question
(a) Alliteration [1 mark]
(b) She is determined / She is compassionate / She is caring / She is responsible. [1 mark]
(c) To create a machine that would purify water / To purify contaminated water and save lives. [1 mark]
(d) The drought had ended / The rain had fallen and the land had become green again / The rain dance [1 mark]
(e) *"Our land is reborn."* [1 mark]
(f) It reveals that Dawuni is a good leader / His leadership helped save the kingdom / He is a responsible and committed leader / He puts the interests of his people first [1 mark]
(g) It presents a busy and chaotic Monday morning / It shows the rush and confusion of people preparing for school and work/A busy, rushed and chaotic Monday morning [1 mark]
(h) Hearing / Auditory sense. [1 mark]
(i) The hectic nature of Monday mornings / Family pressure and school routine. [1 mark]
(j) Imagery [1 mark]

TOTAL = 10 MARKS

PAPER ONE (40 MARKS)

1. A	11. C	21. B	31. D
2. B	12. C	22. A	32. A
3. C	13. B	23. A	33. D
4. C	14. A	24. B	34. A
5. D	15. A	25. D	35. D
6. C	16. D	26. B	36. A
7. B	17. B	27. C	37. C
8. D	18. B	28. D	38. B
9. B	19. D	29. B	39. B
10. B	20. C	30. D	40. C

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